

Steven Spielberg's 2002 movie *Minority Report* envisaged life in 2054, and shows the exceptional full-fledged Augmented Reality at work. For sci-fi fans, the pertinent memory is that scene in the movie when Tom Cruise's character Chief John Anderton strolls through a mall while everything advertised itself by bombarding him with personalized marketing messages. A Guinness billboard calls him by his name and tells him he could use a drink; the Gap store has holograms of assistants who ask him if he's enjoying his previous purchase; an American Express advertising displays a giant 3D credit card embossed with his membership details and so on; you get the idea. This "advertising nirvana" is based upon the possible existence of retinal

scanners; also, computer monitors and displays are transformed into holograms. With the virtual retinal display technology, the image is scanned directly into the retina of human eye. The viewer sees what appears to be a conventional display floating in space. This fancy technology is far from being a figment of your imagination and is currently under development at the University of Washington's Human Interface Technology Laboratory.

Augmented reality is changing the way we see the world. Someday you'll be walking down the street with augmented-reality displays, which will eventually look much like a normal pair of glasses, informative graphics will appear overlaid on your field of view in real time with synced audio.



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